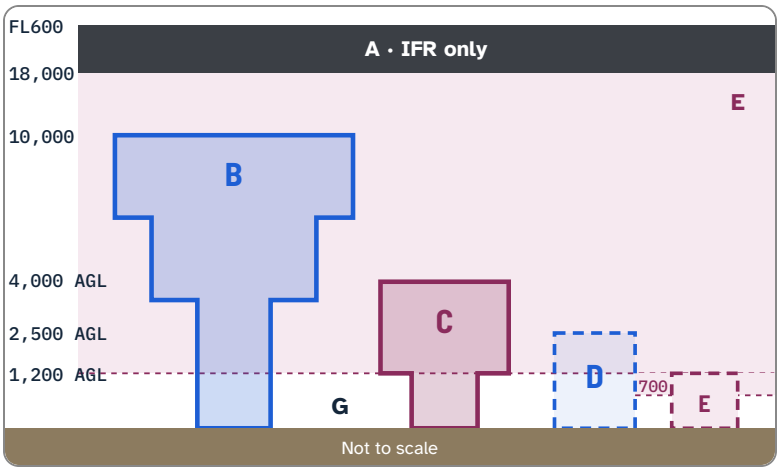
Airspace at a glance

Edition Oct 2026



Colors match the sectional chart: B solid blue, C magenta, D dashed blue, E magenta shading.

3 · 152 3 SM visibility; **1,000** above, **500** below, **2,000** to the side. Class C, D, E below 10,000 MSL, and G at night.

Special VFR: 1 SM and clear of clouds, with an ATC clearance, in a surface area below 10,000 MSL; by day unless instrument rated and IFR equipped. NO SVFR on a chart bars it for fixed-wing aircraft only.

In a surface area: no VFR beneath a ceiling lower than 1,000 ft, and ground visibility must be at least 3 SM to take off, land or enter the pattern (flight visibility if none is reported). Special VFR is the exception.

Right-of-way: a balloon has it over all other categories of aircraft; an aircraft in distress has it over all.

VFR weather minimums

A	18,000 MSL to FL600 — **IFR only**		
B	Any altitude	3 SM	Clear of clouds
C D	Any altitude	3 SM	1,000 / 500 / 2,000 side
E	Below 10,000 MSL	3 SM	1,000 / 500 / 2,000 side
E	At or above 10,000 MSL	5 SM	1,000 / 1,000 / 1 SM side

G	**Day**, 1,200 AGL or less	1 SM	Clear of clouds
G	**Night**, 1,200 AGL or less	3 SM	1,000 / 500 / 2,000 side
G	**Day**, above 1,200 AGL, below 10,000 MSL	1 SM	1,000 / 500 / 2,000 side
G	**Night**, above 1,200 AGL, below 10,000 MSL	3 SM	1,000 / 500 / 2,000 side
G	Above 1,200 AGL, at or above 10,000 MSL	5 SM	1,000 / 1,000 / 1 SM side

To enter, and who may

A	B	C	D	E	G
IFR, ATC clearance	**ATC clearance**	**Two-way radio contact**	**Two-way radio contact**	**None for VFR**	**None**
Instrument rating	Private; student or sport pilot with endorsement	Student	Student	Student	Student

In a balloon: Class B and C, and the airspace above them up to 10,000 MSL, need a transponder and ADS-B Out unless ATC authorizes otherwise; a balloon is not exempt there. A balloon needs neither in the 30 NM Mode C veil if it stays outside Class A, B and C and below the B or C ceiling or 10,000 MSL, whichever is lower, nor in Class E at or above 10,000 MSL (91.215(b)(3) and (b)(5), 91.225(e)). Land well short of Class D airports.

Sources: 14 CFR 91.113(c)–(d), 91.126–91.135, 91.155, 91.157, 61.95, 91.215, 91.225, AIM 3-2, PHAK FAA-H-8083-25C Ch. 15.

Original card, not an FAA document. Study aid, not for navigation.